
Honor Code

Form Title	Honor Code
In place of your signature, please type your full legal name:	Vikas Shrishailappa Badami

Application

Form Title	Application
Area of Academic Focus	
Indicate your primary area of focus:	Management
Indicate your secondary area of focus:	Entrepreneurship
Future Experience	
Please indicate the industry in which you plan to work upon completion of your MBA:	Consulting
Please indicate the functional area in which you plan to work upon completion of your MBA:	Consulting
Dual Degree / Columbia Graduate Programs	
Are you currently enrolled in a graduate program at Columbia University?	No
Are you applying, and not yet enrolled, to a dual degree program?	No
Previous Application	
Have you previously applied to Columbia Business School?	No
Columbia Business School Contact	
Have you ever spoken with a Columbia Business School Program Representative or attended an admissions-sponsored event?	Yes
Please specify admissions staff or alumni with whom you have spoken or what event you have attended.	Chirag Gupta (MS '23) MBAconsultant.com Workshop: Columbia - 14th August 2024 Women of CBS: Admissions Roundtable - 3rd January 2025
Do you know any current students at Columbia Business School?	Yes
Please name these individuals:	Siddhanth Natarajan (MBA '26), Snehal Kukreja (MBA '25), Mukul Goyal (CBS '25), Ranganayaki Venkatraman (MBA '26)
January Consideration	
Would you be interested in being considered for January {{jan_year}} entry in addition to August-entry? Note that your	Yes

Application (continued)

response will not impact your August application decision.

Military

Are you serving (or have you served) in the United States Military? No

Miscellaneous

Were you ever the subject of disciplinary action at a prior academic institution? No

Have you ever been convicted of a crime? (This will not affect your application decision.) No

As part of the Columbia Business School application, I understand that all documents submitted in support of my candidacy are property of Columbia University. Upon submission, I give the school permission to release information from my application and any Yes

Personal

Form Title	Personal
Name	
Prefix	Mr.
First (Given)	Vikas
Middle	Shrishailappa
Last (Family)	Badami
Preferred First	Vikas
Telephone Numbers (include +country code)	
Work	+91 63623 25449
Mobile	+91 94959 50729
Biographical Information	
Birthdate	03/05/1998
Birth Country	India
Native Language	Kannada
Legal Sex	M
Gender Identity optional	Male
Do you identity as LGBTQ+? optional	No
Pronouns optional	He/Him/His
Citizenship Information	
Primary Citizenship	India
Hometown Information	
Where did you grow up?	Ooty, Tamil Nadu India
Language Information	
Language	English Hindi Telugu Tamil Sanskrit
Proficiency	5 - Fluent 4 4 3 - Intermediate 2
Biographical	
Prefix	Mr.

Personal (continued)

First Name	Vikas
Middle Name	Shrishailappa
Last Name	Badami
Preferred Name	Vikas
Sex	Male
Birthdate	03/05/1998
Birthplace	India
Native Language	Kannada

Contact

Email	vikas@peoplegamez.com
Mobile	+91 94959 50729
Evening	+91 63623 25449
Mailing Address	27 Srinivas 1st Main 2nd Cross Rajatgiri Dharwad, Karnataka 580004 India
Permanent Address	27 Srinivas 1st Main 2nd Cross Rajatgiri Dharwad, Karnataka 580004 India

Citizenship

Citizenship Status	Foreign National
Primary Citizenship	India
Do you identify as LGBTQ? (optional)	No

Hometown Information

Location	Ooty, Tamil Nadu India
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Language Information

Language #1

Language	English
Proficiency	5 - Fluent

Language #2

Language	Telugu
Proficiency	4

Language #3

Language	Hindi
Proficiency	4

Language #4

Language	Tamil
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Personal (continued)

Proficiency	3 - Intermediate
Language #5	
Language	Sanskrit
Proficiency	2

Family

Form Title	Family
Parent 1 Information	
First Name	Shrishailappa
Last Name	Badami
mother/parent 1	Dharwad, Karnataka India
Current or most recent (if retired) occupation/employer	Principal / SDM University
Institution(s) Attended/ Degree(s) Obtained	Government College of Pharmacy, Bangalore / B Pharm Government College of Pharmacy, Bangalore / M Pharm Gulbarga University / PhD
Still Living?	Yes
Parent 2 Information	
First Name	Sukumari
Last Name	H U
father/parent 2	Dharwad, Karnataka India
Current or most recent (if retired) occupation/employer	Doctor / Chaitanya Vikas Yoga and Nature Cure Clinic
Institution(s) Attended/ Degree(s) Obtained	JSS College of Naturopathy / BNYS Kuvempu University / MS in Counselling and Psychotherapy
Still Living?	Yes
Spouse/Partner/Significant Other Information	
Marital Status	Single
Do you have any children?	No
Relatives at Columbia	
Do you have a domestic partner/significant other or relative who is currently submitting an application to Columbia University?	No

Employment

Form Title	Employment
I certify my employment (start date, end date, salary, bonus, etc.) is accurate. I will notify the Admissions Office at immediately if anything changes.apply@gsb.columbia.edu	Yes
Enter the total number of months of full-time, post-undergraduate work experience you will have upon enrolling. Please use whole numbers and use a if necessary. data calculator	47
Are you currently an employee of Columbia University?	No
Are you providing a letter of recommendation from your current (or most recent) supervisor?	No
If not, please explain:	In my current organization, as founder and CEO, I do not have direct supervisors. However, I am submitting a recommendation from my mentor and advisor, Rishi, and our client, Solomon.
Do you have plans to work for your family business at some point during your career?	No

Employment Info

Job #1

Organization Name	Metaxp Private Limited (PeopleGamez.com)
Dates of Employment	04/2022 - Present
Starting Position	Chief Executive Officer
Ending Position	Chief Executive Officer
Description	As CEO and Co-Founder of PeopleGamez, I lead strategy, business development, and program delivery overseeing strategic pivots, securing global facilitators, and driving international expansion. I also deliver train-the-trainer programs, equipping global facilitators and coaches with our simulations to maximize their impact.
Starting Compensation	Annual Base: \$5,800.00 Annual Bonus: \$0.00
Ending Compensation	Annual Base: \$2,740.00 Annual Bonus: \$0.00
Location	Dharwad, Karnataka, India
Phone	+91 91487 22085
Direct/Indirect Reports	1
Function	Entrepreneur/Owner
Industry	Consulting
Hours	70
Employees	2
Revenue	42000.00

Job #2

Organization Name	Madiee Games Private Limited
Dates of Employment	08/2021 - 03/2022
Starting Position	Consultant
Ending Position	Chief Operating Officer
Description	Co-founded Madiee, scaling the team from 2 to 118 while scaling processes for efficiency. Led game design, hiring strategy, and strategic partnerships to enhance operations and deliver innovative team-building solutions for diverse clients.
Starting Compensation	Annual Base: \$0.00 Annual Bonus: \$0.00
Ending Compensation	Annual Base: \$0.00 Annual Bonus: \$0.00
Location	Erode, Tamil Nadu, India
Phone	+91 95668 76633
Direct/Indirect Reports	14
Function	Entrepreneur/Owner
Industry	Consulting
Hours	70
Employees	118
Revenue	30000.00

Employment Info (continued)

Reason for Departure	Although Senthil and I shared a broader vision, our perspectives differed on the organization's direction and pace. Recognizing the value of pursuing individual approaches, we made the mutual decision to part ways.
How many months of post-college full-time work experience will you have upon enrolling?	47
Are you currently an employee of Columbia University?	No
Are you providing a letter of recommendation from your current (or most recent) supervisor?	No
If not, please explain:	In my current organization, as founder and CEO, I do not have direct supervisors. However, I am submitting a recommendation from my mentor and advisor, Rishi, and our client, Solomon.
Do you have plans to work for your family business at some point during your career?	No

Education

Form Title	Education
Undergraduate GPA	8.18
Please list any professional credentials received (e.g. CFA, CPA, non-degree certificates):	I have completed several Coursera certifications including Successful Negotiation, Leading Teams, Influencing People, Inspiring and Motivating Individuals, and AI for Medical Diagnosis and Prognosis. These courses enhanced my leadership, communication, and technical skills.
Master's/Doctoral Level #1	
Institution	Plaksha University
Dates of Attendance	08/2020 - 07/2021
Location	Gurugram, Haryana, India
Primary Language is English	Yes
Degree	M.Oth: 08/2021
Field of Study	Management
Major	Tech Leadership
GPA	3.49 / 4
Awards	100% Merit Scholarship - Aug 2020 Jagriti Yatra - Dec 2020 (Top 1% selected from 15k+ applicants with 90% scholarship for exemplary community contributions and proven societal impact.) UC Berkeley's Global Venture Catalyst - Jan 2021 (1 of 170 students from top global universities and MBA programs across 30+ countries) Harvard US India Initiative - Feb 2021 (1 of 100 delegates for academic excellence, leadership potential, social commitment, and diverse experience) Host at Ecoversity's Re-imagining Education International Conference - Mar 2021 (As one of the 12 organizers, I engaged stakeholders from 47 countries to explore transformative educational models)
Undergraduate/Bachelor's Level #1	
Institution	NIT Calicut
Dates of Attendance	07/2016 - 05/2020
Location	Calicut, Kerala, India
Primary Language is English	Yes
Degree	BE: 09/2020
Field of Study	Engineering
Major	Production Engineering
GPA	8.18 / 10
Awards	NITC KhoKho Captain - 2016 - 2020 Finalist in National Defence Competition - Mar 2018 (Among the 14 teams

Education (continued)

selected from across South India (the only team among 20+ participating teams from NIT Calicut), selected for innovation, feasibility, and 18 other criteria. Received special recognition from the DRDO Director for our unique approach to the problem statement.)

Semi-Finalist at Flipkart Grid ML Challenge - Feb 2019 (selected among 6700 teams Nationwide)

Finalist at VNIT Nagpur Startup Conclave - Mar 2019 (My Artificially Intelligent Messaging Tent Prototype was selected among the Top 10 startup ideas from 1000+ nationwide applicants)

Finalist at Kerala XR Challenge - July 2019 (Our industrial XR app prototype was selected among top 10 ideas in Statewide competition)

TEQUIP 3 research grant - Aug 2019 (Our project, Soft Robotics Gripper won a grant from the Ministry of Education for its technical innovation and Industrial relevance)

Pi School of AI - Dec 2019 (I was selected from 6000+ applicants.)

8.18

Undergraduate GPA

Please list any professional credentials received (e.g. CFA, CPA):

I have completed several Coursera certifications including Successful Negotiation, Leading Teams, Influencing People, Inspiring and Motivating Individuals, and AI for Medical Diagnosis and Prognosis. These courses enhanced my leadership, communication, and technical skills.

Extracurricular Activities

Form Title Extracurricular Activities

Hobbies

Please list other activities or interests that you regularly engage in:

I design and run inner and outward discovery-focused outbound trails, adventures, and indoor experiences, typically with a small community of audience who are open to being vulnerable with strangers and embracing new experiences. Board games, trekking, hitchhiking, etc are some of the tools I leverage. I am also authoring my first novel, an Entrepreneur's Mahabharat renarrating the Indian Epic Mahabharat from an organizational development lens.

Activity #1

Type	Post College
Role	Mentor
Organization Name	Learning Wheels
Location	Bangalore, Karnataka, India
Dates of Participation	08/01/2021 - Present
Frequency	5 hour(s) per week 30 week(s) per year
Description	I'm helping 18 founders, most of them college dropouts, pro bono on strategic dilemmas and entrepreneurial struggles.

Activity #2

Type	During College
Role	Founder, Facilitator
Organization Name	OpenTech
Location	Multiple Locations, India
Dates of Participation	10/01/2016 - 05/01/2021
Frequency	15 hour(s) per week 52 week(s) per year
Description	Built a team of 22 volunteers and trained 10000+ underprivileged students on robotics, AI and leadership

Activity #3

Type	Post College
Role	Volunteer Facilitator
Organization Name	ViPo, SDMC, etc (Board Game Communities)
Location	Multiple locations, India
Dates of Participation	12/01/2022 - Present
Frequency	8 hour(s) per week 30 week(s) per year
Description	Twice a month, I facilitate powerful yet fun board games spreading happiness and helping strangers bond as they take away a learning or two after every game.

Activity #4

Type	During College
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Extracurricular Activities (continued)

Role	Captain
Organization Name	KhoKho
Location	Calicut, Kerala, India
Dates of Participation	08/01/2008 - Present
Frequency	14 hour(s) per week 52 week(s) per year
Description	State-level champion, national player, and former school captain. For the last 16 years to this day, I start my mornings with the sport, which keeps me grounded and focused while honing my leadership and strategic skills.

Activity #5

Type	Post College
Role	Evaluating and Mentoring Startups
Organization Name	TreeForest Capital
Location	Bangalore, Karnataka, India
Dates of Participation	01/01/2022 - Present
Frequency	5 hour(s) per week 24 week(s) per year
Description	Helping Treeforest Capital, a family fund evaluate startups and mentor founders on growth and strategy. Among the two ventures I recommended for investment, one recently won funding at SharkTank India. Previously I had worked in a similar role with Act grants and at Jagriti Enterprise Center

Activity #6

Type	During College
Role	Team Lead
Organization Name	Robotics Interest Group
Location	Calicut, Kerala, India
Dates of Participation	11/01/2016 - 02/01/2018
Frequency	15 hour(s) per week 52 week(s) per year
Description	Lead 5 projects - Wall Climbing Robot, Micro-Aerial Vehicle, Quadrupod, Deep reinforcement learning-based self-balancing robot, and SAND (Soldier Assistance and Navigation Device)

Please list other activities or interests that you regularly engage in:

I design and run inner and outward discovery-focused outbound trails, adventures, and indoor experiences, typically with a small community of audience who are open to being vulnerable with strangers and embracing new experiences. Board games, trekking, hitchhiking, etc are some of the tools I leverage. I am also authoring my first novel, an Entrepreneur's Mahabharat renarrating the Indian Epic Mahabharat from an organizational development lens.

Essays

Form Title	Essays
Short Answer	
What is your immediate post-MBA professional goal? (50 characters)	Work as a strategy consultant at Kearney
Short Answer 2	
How do you plan to spend the summer after the first year of the MBA? If in an internship, please include target industry(ies) and/or function(s). If you plan to work on your own venture, please indicate a focus of business. (50 characters)	Interning as strategy consultant at Oliver Wyman
Essay 1	
Widget: Essay 1 - MBA/EMBA	Uploaded 01/07/2025
Essay 2	
{% if {{jan}} == 'Y' %}Describe a time or situation when you had the need to utilize one of these five skills, and tell us the actions you took and the outcome. {% else %}Please respond to one of the below (250 words): {% endif %}(Maximum 250 words) De	Uploaded 01/07/2025
Essay 3	
Widget: Essay 3 - MBA Only	Uploaded 01/07/2025
Optional Essay	
If you wish to provide the Admissions Committee with further information or additional context about your application, please include it here. You may write an essay or submit bullet points. (Maximum 500 Words)	Uploaded 01/07/2025
Optional Essay	
Is there something else you feel would be helpful for the Admissions Committee to know? An optional third essay will allow you to discuss any	Uploaded 01/07/2025

Essays (continued)

topics that do not fall within the
purview of the required essays.
These might include, but are not
limited to:

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Test Scores

GMAT Exam (Focus Edition)

GMAT Exam (Focus Edition)	Self-Reported Score
	Date: 04/08/2024
	Total: 695 (98%)
	Verbal Reasoning: 85 (96%)
	Quantitative Reasoning: 84 (85%)
	Data Insights: 84 (98%)
	1

Recommendation

Form Title	Recommendation
Reference #1	
Name	Mr. Solomon Salvis
Organization	Simurise Learning Private Limited
Title	Chief Executive Officer
Relationship	Client
Phone	+91 93226 06868
Email	solomon@simurise.com
Waiver	The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act of 1974 (Buckley Amendment) allows you to access your educational records if you enroll at Columbia University. You may waive your right of access to this specific report if you so choose. Your decision to waive or not to waive your right of access will have no bearing on the handling of your application.
Waiver Response	I waive my right to access this report.
Waiver Signature	Vikas Shrishailappa Badami
Certification	I confirm that I did not write any portion of this recommendation, either in whole or in part, or have any involvement in its drafting or submission.
Certification Signature	Vikas Shrishailappa Badami
Recommendation Requested	01/04/2025
Recommendation Submitted	01/06/2025

Financing Your MBA

Form Title	Financing Your MBA
Fellowship Consideration	
I would like to be considered for merit fellowships.	Yes
Institutional Funding Consideration	
Do you intend to apply for <code>{% if {{round_key}} == 'MBA-JN' %}a need-based scholarship?{% elif {{round_key}} == 'MBA-RD' %}need-based institutional funding?{% endif %}</code>	Yes
Loans	
Do you plan to utilize student loans to finance the MBA program?	Yes
Estimate the amount of student loans you will borrow (\$ USD)	113000
Self/Family Financial Resources	
Self	15000
Family	5000
Employer/Company Sponsorship	
Will your company be financially sponsoring your MBA program studies?	No
Scholarships/Fellowships	
Have you secured any external scholarships or fellowships?	No
Other Funding Agency (e.g. government scholarship, Veteran Benefits)	
Will you receive any other funding from an outside agency that is not your company?	No
Estimated Remaining Costs	
MBA: Estimated First Year Remainder	\$0



Community Contract

Form Title	Community Contract
I Acknowledge	Yes

Vikas Badami

Dharwad, India | (+91) 9495950729 | vikas@peoplegamez.com | linkedin.com/in/vikasbadami/

Experience

PeopleGamez.com

CEO, Co-Founder

Dharwad, India

Apr 2022 – Present

Strategy consulting firm with \$42K ARR catalyzing growth of purpose driven ventures with strategic realignment by leveraging gamification and data science. I lead a team of 8-15 freelancers and oversee strategy, business development, and client deliverables.

- Spearheaded the expansion of PeopleGamez simulations to 40,000+ learners globally by establishing strategic partnerships with trainers in 7 countries. Established competitive differentiation through localized distribution & tailored value proposition.
- Secured \$21K funding from two Central Government ministries for innovation, the only venture chosen among 36 at our incubator.
- Redesigned the company's operational model by establishing cross-functional workflows and data-driven performance tracking, creating a plug-and-play framework for freelancers. This reduced human dependency and cut operational costs by 50%.
- Recognized as a global thought leader in data driven simulations; Delivered sessions at multiple international conferences including ILYF Global Business Conclave (10000+ footfall), Gamicon48v, SeriousPlayConf (Canada), and AEE Conference (Singapore).

Representative project work

- Repositioned GrowthPal, a Singapore based M&A marketplace as an extended CFO team, establishing a recurring revenue model. Drove international expansion, boosting deal value by 6x, and reduced the sales cycle by 40% by pivoting to family-run ventures.
- Innovated a first-of-its-kind gamified tool to capture organizational needs and team energy for Juice Inc, a Canadian consultancy firm contributing to 35% of revenue and an increase in referral rate by 30%.
- Convinced US-based serial entrepreneur to pivot his fintech venture, Jugad, despite existing VC commitments, in favor of our alternative proposal detailing audience segmentation, competitive benchmarking and value proposition alignment.

MADIEE Games

COO, Co-Founder

Erode, India

Aug 2021 – Mar 2022

Corporate training consulting firm specialising in team development and organizational integration, leveraging simulations. I scaled the team from 2 to 118 members (mostly interns) designing 24 simulations, establishing workflows and growing operations.

- Nurtured a second line of leadership, spearheading strategic partnerships with government and private entities, scaling revenue 12x.
- Demonstrated business case and executed end-to-end executive development programs for Amazon, SHRM, Genpact, Dr. Reddy's, NTUC, etc. upskilling 800 executives on Business Acumen, Team Dynamics, Change management, etc.
- Persuaded MLAs and government stakeholders for gaming industry incentive policy through roundtables and one-on-one meetings leading to the implementation of a new policy (AVGC – XR Policy).
- Won Government of India's flagship Toycathon (129K participants) for our game based on MIT-JWEL's Human Skills Matrix.

Education

PLAKSHA UNIVERSITY | PGDM

Tech Leaders Fellowship, GPA: 3.49/4; (100% merit scholarship)

Gurgaon, India

Aug 2020 – Jul 2021

- Selected as a global venture catalyst delegate by UC Berkeley to create innovative AI-based solutions for enhancing operational efficiency in collaboration with 170 students from 30+ countries; Led "AI in Innovation" panel at the Harvard US-India Initiative.
- Organized Ecoversity's (un-schoolers community) Re-imagining Education Conference, engaging stakeholders from 47 countries.

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, CALICUT | BTech

Production Engineering, GPA: 8.2/10;

Calicut, India

Jul 2016 – May 2020

- Youngest Global AI Scholar (Pi School of AI, Italy): Selected from 6,000+ candidates, earning a special 21st spot out of 20 for exceptional potential. Travelled to Italy to spearhead a solution for a problem worth \$270M for my sponsor, OctoTelematics.

Other

- Founded OpenTech, upskilling 10000+ underprivileged students from 30+ institutes on AI and Robotics with 22 volunteers.
- Conceptualized 'Project Uplift', a top 3 Asian project by UPG, a UN wing, for leadership development in underprivileged students.
- Awarded Youth Icon by the Ministry of Youth Affairs, Government of India. Chosen as one of 40 national trainers to guide and mentor top entrepreneurs selected from 100000+ applicants across India, driving excellence and entrepreneurial growth.
- Trained young leaders on 21st century leadership skills at Synthesis, backed by Elon Musk, as one among their first hires from Asia.
- Top 1% selected among 15k+ social changemakers for 'Jagriti Yatra'. Mentored 'New Roshani Sanitary Pads', a startup incubated at 'Jagriti Enterprise Center', driving Sanitary Pad adoption by 5000+ rural women. Led volunteers for Kerala Floods (2018, 2019).



PLAKSHA TECH LEADERS FELLOWSHIP
One year full-time Postgraduate program

Name: Vikas S Badami
Enrolment ID: TLF0120061

OFFICIAL TRANSCRIPT
Year: August 2020 - July 2021

Code	Course Title	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	Credits	Grade
TERM 1							
C-L 001	Designing Our Lives	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	A
C-M 001	Introduction to Programming and Python	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1.5	A-
C-M 002	Mathematics for Artificial Intelligence	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1.5	B+
E-M 003	Introduction to Computing Infrastructure	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	A
Credits Earned: 5		PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	GPA: 3.7	
TERM 2							
C-M 004	Machine Learning 1	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	A-
C-M 005	Machine Learning Lab 1	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	A
C-L 002	Persuasive P	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	A
E-M 006	Decisions, Risks and Optimization	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	A-
C-T 001	Perspectives on Grand Challenges for Engineering	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	B-
C-M 007	Projects and applications of Data Science - Part 1	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	A
Credits Earned: 4		PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	GPA: 3.73	
TERM 3							
C-M 008	Machine Learning 2	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	A
C-M 009	Machine Learning Lab 2	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	A
C-T 002	Design Thinking	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	A
E-T 003	Role of Markets	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	A
C-L 003	Leadership & Performance	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	A
C-T 004	Grand Challenge Lecture Series: Health	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	A
E-M 010	Projects and applications of Data Science - Part 2	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	A
Credits Earned: 5.5		PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	GPA: 4	
TERM 4							
C-R 001	Entrepreneurial Challenge Lab 1	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1.5	C+
C-M 011	Natural Language Processing	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	C+
C-L 004	Writing and Communication	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	1	B+
C-T 006	Grand Challenge Lecture Series: Energy	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	A
E-M 012	Introduction to Distributed Systems	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	0.5	A
Credits Earned: 4.5		PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	PLAKSHA	GPA: 2.9	

Code	Course Title	Credits	Grade
TERM 5			
C-R 002	Entrepreneurial Challenge Lab 2	1.5	C+
E-T 007	Tech Product Management	1	A-
C-L 005	Group Dynamics	1	Pass
C-L 006	Persuasive Presence Part-2	0.5	A
Credits Earned: 4		GPA: 3.05	
TERM 6			
C- R 003	Capstone Project - Industry, Research, Start-up	6	A-
Credits Earned: 6		GPA: 3.7	
TERM 7			
C-T 009	Grand Challenge Lecture Series: Fintech	1	A-
E-T 010	Design Thinking: Cycle of Data Driven Products for Maximizing Business Outcome	1	A-
E-T 011	Data Visualisation		AU
E-T 012	Social Entrepreneurship	1	A-
C-T 015	Law, Society and Technology	1	C
Credits Earned: 4		GPA: 3.28	
TERM 8			
E-M 013	Data Science with Interpretable Models	1	A
C-L 007	Leadership at the Workplace	0.5	Pass
C-L 008	Persuasive Presence Part - 3	0.5	F
Credits Earned: 1.5		GPA: 2.67	
Total Credits Earned: 34.5		CGPA: 3.49	
Total Credits Offered: 38.0			
Minimum Passing Credits : 34.0			



Verify as per instructions at verify.plaksha.org



Program Director

Badami, Vikas; DOB: 03/05/1999;



Verify as per instructions at verify.plaksha.org

Program Director

PRINT DATE: 12/07/2021

PLAKSHA TECH LEADERS FELLOWSHIP
OFFICIAL TRANSCRIPT



Plaksha Tech Leaders Fellowship (TLF) is a one year, fully residential, postgraduate program located in Gurugram, Haryana, India. It is co-designed and co-delivered by the Reimagining Higher Education Foundation in partnership with the Sutardja Center for Entrepreneurship and Technology at the University of California, Berkeley. The Reimagining Higher Education Foundation is a not-for-profit organization based in India and established by a group of academic and business leaders to reimagine technology education and research in India. The Fellowship aims to nurture leaders in technology who design ethical, scalable tech-centric solutions, are innovative and entrepreneurial, and drive impact.

TLF Curriculum

The Plaksha Tech Leaders Fellowship is delivered by 30+ high calibre visiting faculty from institutions such as UC Berkeley, Purdue University, University of Pennsylvania, University of Maryland, Tata Institute of Fundamental Research and many others. Practitioners from organizations such as Google and Microsoft Research are also a part of the faculty. The Fellowship spans across 8 academic terms of approximately 6 weeks each covering a total of 38 credits.

Entrepreneurial Challenge Lab -

The Entrepreneurial Challenge Lab is a mini-entrepreneurial journey spread across 8 weeks, aimed at simulating the environment of a start-up as part of the academic rigour. It is aimed at fostering business acumen while focusing on discovering or developing technology-related solutions.

Capstone Project -

The Capstone Project is an 8 weeks long, full time paid internship position that the fellows hold at a corporate organization or a research institution. Fellows are required to work on a pre-defined problem statement typically involving the application of technology to a real-world problem. Fellows can also work on a start-up idea, under the guidance and mentorship of industry leaders, as part of the Capstone Project.

Course descriptions are available at <https://plaksha.org/techleaders/program>.

Credits and Grading Policy

Each term's course load is 4-6 credits. Each credit is defined as 20 hours of classroom lecture time, with additional time for tutorials, office hours, field trips etc. Courses are divided into 3 categories: core, and elective

Core : The core courses are in Data Science, Machine Learning, AI and in Self and Leadership.

Elective : A student can choose to opt-in for an elective course based on their credit requirements to pass the program. These courses can be audited.

Earned Credits

A student earns the course credits when they receive a grade of 'D' or higher in a course.

Minimum Passing Credits

A student is required to earn a minimum of 34 credits in order to graduate from the program. Students receive a final letter grade for every course. These grades are calibrated to the GPA grade points. The grid below explains the relationship between the grades and their grade points.

Letter Grade	A	B	C	D	F
Grade Point	4.00	3.00	2.00	1.00	0.00

The program's grade point scale is A=4.0, B=3.0, C=2.0, D=1, F=0. Pass. Plus (+) or minus (-) may also be recorded. Grades with a plus sign (such as B+) carry 0.3 points more per unit; minus grades (such as A-) carry 0.3 points less.

Pass/Fail: Pass or Fail are assigned by the instructor and are based on fulfilling the criteria laid down by the instructor. A course taken on a Pass/Fail basis does not earn any credits.

Audit (AU): A successful completion of Audit is provided by the instructor and is based on fulfilling the criteria laid down by the instructor. A course taken on an audit basis does not earn any credits.

Withdrawn (W): In exceptional circumstances, a Fellow may be allowed to withdraw from a course. The 'W' grade does not carry any GPA points and fellows do not earn any credits for a course they are withdrawn from.

Non-contributory letter grades (Not contributing towards the CGPA)

S = Satisfactory; U = Unsatisfactory; W = Withdrawn; AU = Audit; R = Result Withheld/ Awaited

Grade Point Average

Each grade has a grade point associated with it (as detailed in the Table above). Only courses with letter grades A to F will contribute towards the calculation of CGPA, which is the weighted average of the grade points of all the earned credits.

In case of any query, contact the following: Office of Academic Affairs: academics@plaksha.org
Reimagining Higher Education Foundation: Plot 17, Phase-4, Udyog Vihar, Sector 19, Gurugram, Haryana-122022. Call: +91 73035 80960



राष्ट्रीय प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान कालिकट

National Institute of Technology Calicut

 Sl.No. $\frac{A}{11}$ **017568**

NIT Campus (PO), Kozhikode, Kerala, India, PIN - 673 601

Ref. No. 11 20/BTECH/0906

Dated : 14 Aug 2020

CONSOLIDATED GRADE CARD

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY

 Name : **Mr/Ms VIKAS S BADAMI**

 Roll No : **B160906PE**

Month and year of admission : Jul-2016

 Branch : **PRODUCTION ENGINEERING**

Course Code	Course Title	Credit	Category	Grade	Att. Code
Semester : Monsoon Semester 2016-2017 (July 16 - December 16)					
CY1001	CHEMISTRY	3	BS	A	H
CY1094	CHEMISTRY LAB	1	BS	A	H
MA1001	MATHEMATICS I	3	BS	A	H
ZZ1004	COMPUTER PROGRAMMING	2	ES	A	H
ZZ1092	WORKSHOP II	2	TA	A	H
MS1001	PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION	3	HL	B	H
ZZ1001	ENGINEERING MECHANICS	3	ES	C	H
Semester : Winter Semester 2016-2017 (January 17 - June 17)					
MA1002	MATHEMATICS II	3	BS	A	H
ME1001	INTRODUCTION TO MECHANICAL ENGINEERING	2	PT	A	N
PH1001	PHYSICS	3	BS	A	N
ZZ1091	WORKSHOP I	2	TA	A	H
ZZ1002	ENGINEERING GRAPHICS	3	TA	C	N
ZZ1003	BASIC ELECTRICAL SCIENCES	3	ES	C	N
PH1091	PHYSICS LAB	1	BS	S	H
Semester : Monsoon Semester 2017-2018 (July 17 - December 17)					
MA2001	MATHEMATICS - III	3	BS	B	H
ME2002	ELEMENTS OF SOLID MECHANICS	3	PT	B	N
ME2091	MACHINE DRAWING	2	PT	B	H
EE2009	ELECTRICAL MEASUREMENTS AND MACHINES	3	PT	C	N
ME2003	ENGINEERING MECHANICS-DYNAMICS	3	PT	C	N
ME2101	MATERIALS SCIENCE AND METALLURGY	3	PT	C	N
ME2004	FLUID MECHANICS AND MACHINERY	3	PT	D	N
CE 2095	STRENGTH OF MATERIALS LABORATORY	2	PT	S	H
Semester : Winter Semester 2017-2018 (January 18 - June 18)					
ME2092	FLUID MECHANICS & FLUID MACHINERY LABORATORY	2	PT	A	H
ME2111	ESSENTIALS OF MANAGEMENT	3	HL	A	N
ME2191	PRODUCTION TECHNOLOGY LABORATORY I	2	PT	A	H
ME2013	MECHANICS OF MACHINERY	3	PT	B	H
ME2112	METAL CASTING AND JOINING	3	PT	B	N
MA2002	MATHEMATICS - IV	3	BS	D	N
ME2015	THEORY OF ELASTICITY AND PLASTICITY	3	PT	D	N
ME2016	THERMODYNAMICS AND HEAT TRANSFER	3	PT	S	N
Semester : Monsoon Semester 2018-2019 (July 18 - December 18)					
ME3103	MACHINE TOOLS	3	PT	A	N
ME3105	PRODUCTION MANAGEMENT	4	PT	A	N
ME3001	DYNAMICS OF MACHINERY	3	PT	C	N
ME3104	METROLOGY AND COMPUTER AIDED INSPECTION	3	PT	C	N
ME3192	METROLOGY AND INSTRUMENTATION LABORATORY	2	PT	C	N
ME3194	PRODUCTION TECHNOLOGY LABORATORY - II	2	PT	C	H
ME3024	CONTROL SYSTEMS ENGINEERING	3	PT	D	N

NAME: VIKAS S BADAMI

ROLL NO : B160906PE

Semester : Winter Semester 2018-2019 (January 19 - June 19)					
EE3035 - G	BIOMEDICAL INSTRUMENTATION (GE)	3	GE	A	N
ME3092	THERMAL ENGINEERING LAB	2	PT	A	H
ME3114	CAD/CAM/CIM	3	PT	A	N
ME3126	SUPPLY CHAIN MANAGEMENT	3	PT	A	H
ME3195	CAD/CAM/CIM LAB	2	PT	A	H
ME3014	DESIGN OF MACHINE ELEMENTS	4	PT	B	N
ME3113	QUANTITATIVE TECHNIQUES FOR MANAGEMENT	3	PT	B	N
ME3013	THERMAL ENGINEERING	3	PT	C	H
Semester : Monsoon Semester 2019-2020 (July 19 - December 19)					
ME4098	PROJECT	3	PT	A	H
ME4103	TOOL ENGINEERING AND DESIGN	4	PT	A	N
ME4192	MANAGEMENT SCIENCE LABORATORY	2	PT	A	H
ME4193	METAL CUTTING LABORATORY	2	PT	A	N
ME4102	THEORY OF METAL CUTTING	4	PT	B	N
FE4021-GE	ARTIFICIAL NEURAL NETWORKS AND GENETIC ALGORITHMS(GE)	3	GE	C	N
Semester : Winter Semester 2019-2020 (January 20 - June 20)					
ME4111	INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING	3	PT	A	H
ME3027D	FLUID POWER CONTROLS	3	PT	B	N
MS4004	INDUSTRIAL ECONOMICS	3	HL	B	N
ME4097	SEMINAR	1	PT	S	N
ME4099	PROJECT	5	PT	S	H
Semester : Others (OT) [Pass (P)/Fail (F) Type]					
ZZ1093	PHYSICAL EDUCATION	1	OT	P	N
ZZ1094	OT(VALUE EDUCATION)	1	OT	P	N
ZZ1095	NATIONAL SERVICE SCHEME	1	OT	P	N
ME3003	ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES FOR MECHANICAL ENGINEERS	3	OT	P	H

CGPA= 8.18

Accumulated Credits

Category	BS	ES	HL	TA	PT	GE	OT	Total
Credits	20	8	9	7	104	6	6	160

Checked By :

1. 
 2. 



Deputy Registrar (Academic)

Grade	S	A	B	C	D	E	R	F	W
Grade Points	10	9	8	7	6	5	4	0	0
Category	Code		Minimum cumulative credit to be earned						
Basic Sciences	BS		20						
Basic Engineering Sciences	ES		8						
Technical Arts	TA		7						
Humanities & Languages	HL		9						
Professional Theory and Lab Practicals	PT		104						
Global Electives	GE		6						
Others	OT		6						

CGPA (Cumulative Grade Point Average) = $\sum (C \times GP) / \sum C \rightarrow$ Summation is taken over all the courses registered for upto the final semester.
 The CGPA Conversion to Percentage = $(CGPA - 0.5) \times 10$
 Pass/Fail courses are not included for computation of CGPA. * Credited by taking more than one chance

Attendance Code :

H - 90% and above
 N - 80% and above, but less than 90%
 L - Below 80%

CGPA 8 and above : First Class with Distinction
 CGPA 6.5 and above, but less than 8 : First Class
 CGPA 5 and above, but less than 6.5 : Second Class

Leadership has always fascinated me, not as a position of authority but as a catalyst for transformation. During the Jagriti Yatra, an 5000-mile journey with social change-makers, I consulted ventures like a sustainable textile business empowering rural women. Despite their potential, these businesses faced strategic inefficiencies in market positioning and customer value proposition. Mentoring these ventures and driving impact, I saw how businesses could uplift communities and create lasting change.

At PeopleGamez, this belief has guided my work. Early on, our solutions lacked the depth executives expected, leading to bankruptcy. Forced to lay off my team, I upskilled myself by operating from a board game cafe, working pro bono with thought leaders. These experiences honed my skills in product-led and organic growth strategies, while teaching me stakeholder management and the ability to foster collaboration under pressure.

In one transformative project, I guided a retail company to uncover cultural stigmas affecting its women-focused product line. By empowering the leadership team, we developed a campaign that engaged teachers and community leaders, improving hygiene standards for 25,000 women and driving business growth, showcasing how purpose-driven strategies can create both social and business impact.

This realization evolved into my long-term vision of empowering businesses to become catalysts for societal change. I aim to achieve this by returning to PeopleGamez and establishing it in the United States as a global leader in strategy consulting, helping organizations align purpose with growth and societal impact.

Scaling PeopleGamez internationally revealed several skill gaps. My limited domain knowledge beyond strategic realignments and launching new initiatives prevented me from

winning projects involving corporate diversification, crisis management, navigating regulatory nuances, and brand positioning in culturally diverse markets. Limited large-scale project exposure has deterred clients from extending engagements, while my self-taught financial skills have occasionally caused cash-flow mismanagement, prompting me to seek structured growth through an MBA and post-MBA roles.

CBS's Leadership Codex aligns with the leader I aspire to become and foster through my consultancy. Leveraging Professor Todd Jick's Management 2.0 framework, resources at Reuben Mark Initiative and engaging with leaders like Joe Timko through the Executives in Residence program, I will master leading boundaryless organizations effectively. CBS's proximity to New York will enable me to build relationships with decision-makers, including my existing US clients and Columbia Coaching Certification alumni.

Post-MBA, I aim to build a solid strategic foundation by working as a strategy consultant at Oliver Wyman or Kearney. Alternatively, I aspire to work as an internal consultant at enterprise firms such as Google or Disney. In both of these roles, by leading large-scale project implementation, cross-cultural team management, and global market navigation, I will continue refining my strategic thinking and leadership skills, laying the groundwork for my vision of merging technology, strategy, and purpose-driven leadership through my consulting firm.

Progressing to a senior leadership role, I will influence executive decisions, address organizational inefficiencies, cultivate partnerships with enterprises, tech innovators, and government stakeholders, and drive global transformations, building the foundation before returning to scale impact through PeopleGamez.

I grew up watching my friends abandon their dreams due to lack of resources or mentorship. My high school teachers, juggling multiple jobs, embodied the systemic neglect that stifled aspirations and perpetuated inequity. At NIT Calicut, I witnessed the power of ecosystems in nurturing talent by removing the barriers that keep students from realizing their potential. To create a similar ecosystem empowering underserved students with technology to solve local challenges and dream without limitations, I founded OpenTech workshops during my first semester. However, I faced the very barriers I strived to dismantle.

Colleagues hesitated to volunteer, citing academic pressures.

Students skipped workshops to support their families by working weekends.

When my parents questioned my persistence, I responded, "If I cannot break these barriers, how can I inspire others to?"

My 22-member team and I spent every weekend traveling to India's remotest regions, challenging entrenched norms and convincing hesitant parents to support their children's aspirations beyond generational jobs. By providing autonomy and linking each volunteer's skills to specific impact, I nurtured my team's intrinsic motivation as they initiated teacher training programs and infrastructure partnerships with NGOs.

Over three years, we transformed 10000+ change-seekers into change-makers developing waterbody-cleaning robots and cattle trackers. One student represented India at NASA, while many became entrepreneurs. During the pandemic, a former participant collaborated with me to adapt OpenTech online as Project Uplift, which earned United Nations recognition for community transformation. To me, leadership means building ecosystems that empower individuals and communities to unlock their potential.

At CBS, my ideal MBA destination, I will share frugal venture development strategies for validating diverse business metrics and creating impactful ventures through the Entrepreneur Club. Through the Community Impact Club, I will lead conversations on ecosystem development to address community challenges in developing countries. Drawing on my experience facilitating executive workshops and presenting at international conferences on leadership development, I will host workshops focused on Managerial Coaching for my peers via CBS Well. Inspired by the experiential program I launched at Plaksha, I will initiate the CBS Reverse Mentorship Program, enabling student-led workshops for alumni on emerging fields such as Generative AI and Web3, fostering the exchange of perspectives and deeper alumni engagement.

CBS's global outlook will help me decode the Israeli innovation model through the Block Week class, enhance my understanding of market insights and cultural sensitivities in the Francophone region via the Chazen French Language Program, and refine cross-cultural communication and leadership skills by serving as a Global Ambassador in the Chazen Leadership Fellows Program. Professor Bernd Schmitt's Marketing Innovation Case Competition will further prepare me to navigate and excel in global markets.

Mukul (CBS '25) emphasized CBS's balance between "Tradition and Modernity," which I aim to embrace by solving strategic challenges through Master Classes. Networking with corporate leaders through Immersion Seminars and events like AlleyCon will broaden my perspective across diverse industries. Additionally, I plan to leverage global consulting opportunities via the International Development Consulting Project Fund and gain enterprise exposure through in-term internships.

In this section I wish to address my failing grade at Plaksha, organizational structure at PeopleGamez and my low salary figures, my choice of recommenders and my background.

At Plaksha, I launched Madiie while balancing coursework, supported by the administrative team. A personal emergency of my co-founder forced me to handle a critical project, leading to an attendance shortage in the intensive 2-week 'Persuasive Presence 3' course. This resulted in my failing grade due to insufficient attendance. I kindly request the admissions team to consider my prior academic performance, where I ranked highest with a 4.0/4.0 GPA in both 'Persuasive Presence 1 [CL 002]' and 'Persuasive Presence 2 [CL 006],' as evidence of my academic readiness.

At PeopleGamez, I supervised 8-15 freelancers who were hired on a need basis. I also reinvested profits to build assets and only take director remuneration in emergencies, hence my application lists a near zero salary. However, PeopleGamez is a profitable and bootstrapped venture with \$42K ARR.

In my current organization, as founder and CEO, I do not have direct supervisors. Hence, I am submitting recommendations from my mentor and advisor, Rishi, and my client, Solomon.

I spent all of my childhood in a remote village in the forests of western ghats, a Badaga tribal settlement, and the outskirts of a small town, where diverse cultures shaped my outlook on life and leadership. My mother transformed our rented homes into a green oasis, cultivating plants that attracted birds and provided fresh produce, helping us save costs. The healthy meals cooked in earthen pots and the resourceful ways we met our needs ingrained sustainability into every aspect of my life.

I studied at a \$30-a-year school that attracted children of migrant laborers and underserved communities, creating a vibrant melting pot of cultures and languages. Kho Kho, often called the poor man's sport, became an instrument of unity amidst this diversity. On the field, we learned to communicate across languages, respect each other's strengths, and build unwavering trust despite our different backgrounds. These experiences forged bonds among us and became my first leadership lessons, showing me how collaboration can turn challenges into triumphs.

Whether it's designing sustainable business models through my consulting, frugal venture development with resourcefulness at Madiie or fostering diverse, inclusive teams at PeopleGamez, my leadership philosophy has its foundations in my roots.



My Profile

Your profile is 79% Complete

Complete more of your information to better match your goals to programs

Personal Information

Vikas Shrishallappa Badami
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Please Note: To send scores to programs, select one or more valid scores below. You can send your score report to up to 5 programs for free. Additional score reports cost USD 35 each. Scores are valid for five (5) years from your scores exam date.

APPOINTMENT ID	LOCATION	APPOINTMENT DATE	SCORE PUBLISHED DATE	TOTAL SCORE	NUMBER SENT	SEND SCORE
475105604	Pearson Professional Centers- Bangalore, KAR, IND	April 8, 2024 5:45:00 PM	April 09, 2024 7:41:03 AM	695		Send Score

- Your free score reports for this appointment expired on April 11, 2024 at 7:41:03 AM
- Additional score reports cost USD 35 each. Scores are valid for five (5) years from your exam date.
- Your Total and Section Scores have an associated Percentile. Percentiles show the percentage of scores that your score surpassed. A higher percentile is better.
- Percentiles are based on the mean exam score calculated over the previous five years. Though your score will not change, your percentile ranking may change when the new five-year mean is calculated. [Learn More.](#)

- Total Score
- Quantitative Reasoning
- Verbal Reasoning
- Data Insights

Performance By Section

Section	Your Percentile	Your Score
Total Score	98th	205 ————— 695 ————— 805 Mean: 546
Quantitative Reasoning	85th	60 ————— 84 ————— 90 Mean: 78
Verbal Reasoning	96th	60 ————— 85 ————— 90 Mean: 79
Data Insights	98th	60 ————— 84 ————— 90 Mean: 74

Overall Performance By Program & School

Below is your percentile ranking for your total score for each program you sent your scores to, comparing all test takers who applied to the programs from the most recent 5 years.

<< Previous Section Next Section: Quantitative Reasoning >>

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